

TITLE OF THESIS

A thesis submitted for the degree of
Master of Philosophy (Applied Epidemiology)
of the Australian National University

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YEAR – YEAR

PLACEMENT UNIT,
PLACEMENT DEPARTMENT

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Dr SUPERVISOR NAME

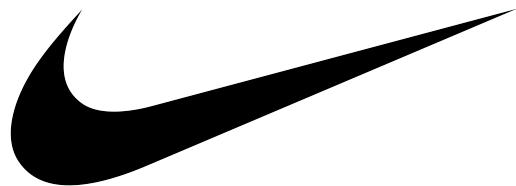
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Mr SUPERVISOR NAME 2



Australian
National
University



Originality Statement

'I hereby declare that this submission is my own work and to the best of my knowledge it contains no materials previously published or written by another person, or substantial proportions of material which have been accepted for the award of any other degree or diploma at the Australian National University or any other educational institution, except where due acknowledgement is made in the thesis. Any contribution made to the research by others, with whom I have worked at PLACEMENT or elsewhere, is explicitly acknowledged in the thesis. I also declare that the intellectual content of this thesis is the product of my own work, except to the extent that assistance from others in the project's design and conception or in style, presentation or linguistic expression is acknowledged'.

Signed: _____

YOUR FULL NAME
DATE OF SUBMISSION

Word count: 30,000

Acknowledgements

I would like to extend my deepest thanks to the many people who have supported me throughout my Master of Philosophy (Applied Epidemiology) (MAE) journey and my time at the...

First, I would like to acknowledge my supervisors...

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Abstract

In this thesis,...

Abbreviations

CDPU	Communicable Disease Prevention Unit
EHU	Environmental Health Unit
MAE	Master of Philosophy (Applied Epidemiology)
PHS	Public Health Services
REDCap	Research Electronic Data Capture

Chapter 1

Placement and MAE experience

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1.1 Overview

The Master of Philosophy (Applied Epidemiology) (MAE) is...

Communicable Disease Prevention Unit (CDPU) sits within Public Health Services (PHS).¹

1.2 Major competencies

1.2.1 Analysis of a public health dataset

PROJECT TITLE 1

Description of project...

1.2.2 Establishing a surveillance system

PROJECT TITLE 2

Description of project...

1.2.3 Design and conduct an epidemiological study

PROJECT TITLE 3

Description of project...

1.2.4 Investigation of a public health problem or threat

PROJECT TITLE 4

Description of project...

1.3 Minor competencies

1.3.1 Literature review search strategy

1.3.2 Report to a non-scientific audience

I developed a factsheet ([Appendix 2.A](#)).

1.3.3 Conference presentation

I presented an outbreak investigation ([Appendix 5.A](#)).

1.3.4 Peer-reviewed publication

A manuscript was prepared for submission ([Appendix 5.B](#)).

1.3.5 Teaching of topics in field epidemiology

I delivered a teaching session ([Chapter 6](#)).

1.4 Coursework

I completed the following coursework units as part of the MAE:

- **POPH8913** Analysis of Public Health Data
- **POPH8914** Issues in Applied Epidemiology
- **POPH8915** Research Design and Methods
- **POPH8916** Outbreak Investigation
- **POPH8917** Public Health Surveillance

References

- [1] Tasmanian Department of Health. *Public Health Services*. 2025. URL: <https://www.health.tas.gov.au/about/public-health-services> [Accessed 26 November 2025].

Chapter 2

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2.1 Prologue

2.1.1 Study rationale

2.1.2 My role

2.1.3 Lessons learnt

2.1.4 Public health impact

2.1.5 MAE competencies addressed

- Analysis of a public health dataset
- Report to a non-scientific audience

2.1.6 Acknowledgements

2.2 Abstract

2.3 Introduction

The is an example of a reference.¹

2.4 Methods

2.4.1 Study period and population

2.4.1.1 Surveillance case definition

2.4.2 Data collection

Environmental Health Unit (EHU) conducted field investigations and interviewed cases. EHU upload the data collected during these investigations to Research Electronic Data Capture (REDCap).

2.4.3 Data cleaning

2.4.4 Data analysis

2.4.5 Ethics

2.5 Results

Table 2.1: Number of cases by age group (not real data).

Age (Years)	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	Total
0-9	10	8	7	9	11	45
10-19	8	9	7	8	9	41
20-29	8	9	8	11	10	46
30-39	7	6	5	5	6	29
40-49	6	5	7	5	5	28
50-59	6	5	6	4	4	25
60-69	5	5	6	5	5	26
70-79	4	5	3	6	4	22
80+	3	4	5	3	4	19
Total	57	56	54	56	58	281

2.6 Discussion

2.7 Limitations

2.8 Conclusion

2.9 Recommendations

Responsible: [Unit/team name]

Recommendation text here.

References

- [1] National Health and Medical Research Council. *NHMRC Information Paper: Evidence on the Effects of Lead on Human Health*. Canberra: National Health and Medical Research Council, 2015.

Appendix 2.A Lay summary

FACT SHEET

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3.1 Prologue

3.1.1 Study rationale

3.1.2 My role

3.1.3 Lessons learnt

3.1.4 Public health impact

3.1.5 MAE competencies addressed

- Establish a surveillance system or health information system
- Teaching field epidemiology

3.1.6 Acknowledgements

3.2 Abstract

Objective

Methods

Results

Conclusion

3.3 Introduction

3.4 Methods

3.4.1 Ethics

3.5 Results

As shown in [Figure 3.1](#), ...



Figure 3.1: Example figure caption.

3.6 Discussion

This is another example of a reference.¹ If the chapter does not have a reference there will be a warning in the overleaf log, just ignore it if you don't need one :)

3.7 Limitations

3.8 Conclusion

3.9 Recommendations

Responsible: [Unit/team name]

Recommendation text here.

References

- [1] Australian Bureau of Statistics. *Standard Australian Classification of Countries (SACC)*, 2016. 2024. URL: <https://www.abs.gov.au/statistics/classifications/standard-australian-classification-countries-sacc/latest-release> [Accessed 8 July 2025].

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4.1.1 Study rationale

4.1.2 My role

4.1.3 Lessons learnt

4.1.4 Public health impact

4.1.5 MAE competencies addressed

- Design and conduct an epidemiological study
- Literature review

4.1.6 Acknowledgements

4.2 Abstract

Objectives

Methods

Results

Conclusion

4.3 Introduction

This is another random reference.¹

4.3.1 Study aim

4.3.2 Study objectives

4.4 Methods

4.4.1 Study period and population

4.4.2 Case definition

4.4.3 Data collection

4.4.4 Study design

4.4.5 Study outcomes

4.4.6 Exposure variables

4.4.7 Data cleaning

4.4.8 Statistical analyses

4.4.9 Ethics

4.5 Results

4.6 Discussion

4.7 Limitations

4.8 Conclusion

4.9 Recommendations

Responsible: [Unit/team name]

Recommendation text here.

References

- [1] Centres for Disease Control and Prevention. *About Norovirus*. Norovirus. 2024. URL: <https://www.cdc.gov/norovirus/about/index.html> [Accessed 28 March 2025].

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PROJECT TITLE 4

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5.1.1 Study rationale

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5.1.3 Lessons learnt

5.1.4 Public health impact

5.1.5 MAE competencies addressed

- Investigation of an acute public health problem (outbreak investigation)
- Conference presentation
- Peer-reviewed publication

5.1.6 Acknowledgements

5.2 Abstract

Background

Methods

Results

Conclusion

5.3 Introduction

5.4 Methods

5.4.1 Epidemiological investigation

5.4.1.1 Data collection

5.4.1.2 Case definition

Confirmed case

Probable case

5.4.1.3 Data management

5.4.1.4 Data analysis

5.4.1.5 Public health action

5.4.1.6 Communication

5.4.2 Environmental health investigation

5.4.3 Laboratory investigation

5.4.3.1 Clinical samples

5.4.3.2 Environmental samples

5.4.4 Ethics

5.5 Results

5.5.1 Epidemiological investigation

5.5.2 Environmental health investigation

5.5.3 Laboratory investigation

5.6 Discussion

Another example of a reference so there's no warnings for this chapter¹

5.7 Limitations

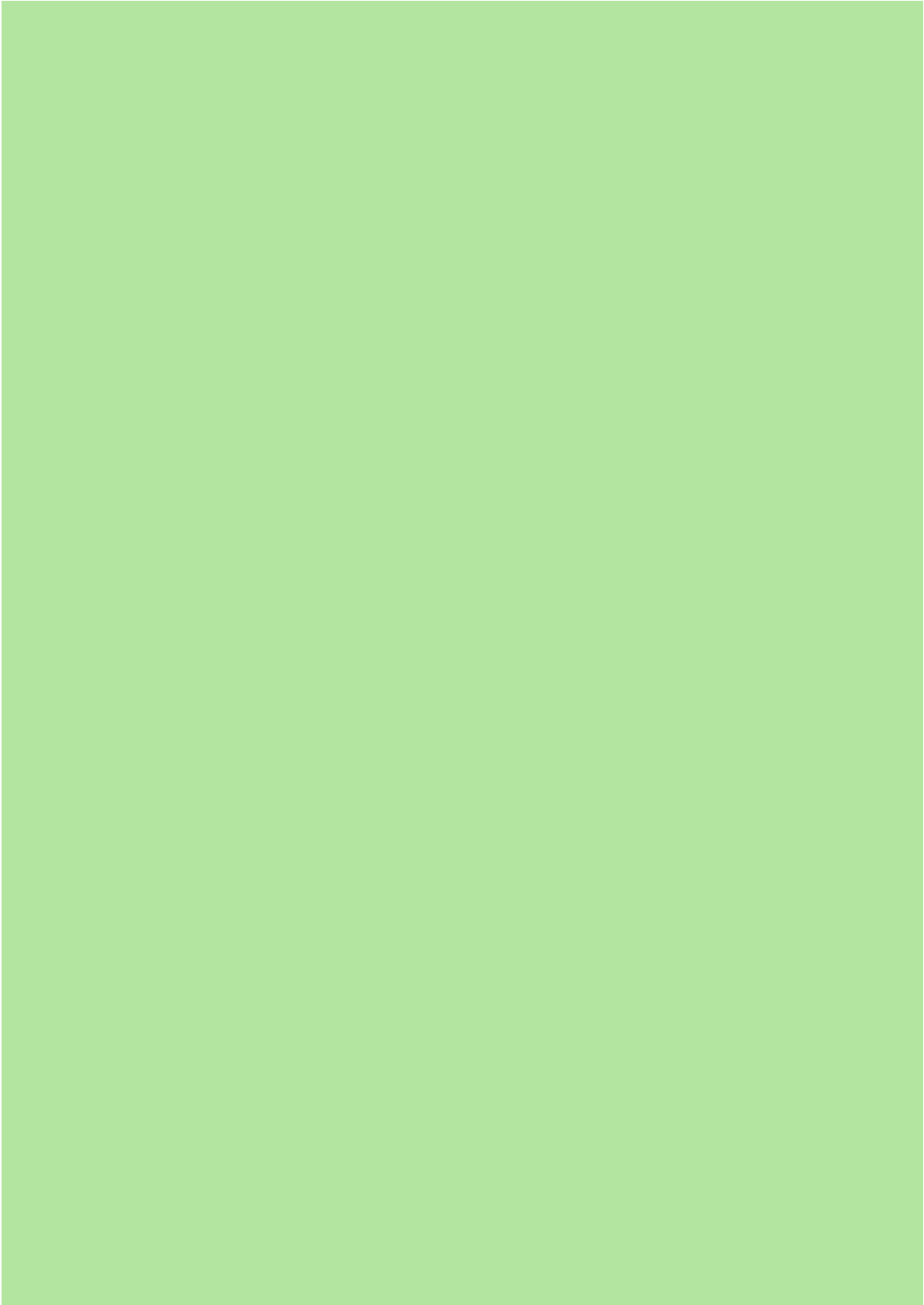
5.8 Conclusion

References

- [1] Tasmanian Department of Health. *Guidelines for Notifying Diseases and Food Contaminants*. 2024. URL: <https://www.health.tas.gov.au/sites/default/files/2024-11/Guidelines%20for%20Notifying%20Diseases%20and%20Food%20Contaminants.pdf> [Accessed 27 April 2025].

Appendix 5.A Conference presentation slides

Conference presentaation slides



Appendix 5.B Manuscript

Manuscript

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Teaching and other field activities

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6.1.1.1 My role

6.1.1.2 Training

6.1.1.3 Evaluation of training

6.1.1.4 Lessons learnt

Another random reference...¹ but this chapter may not need it, so just ignore the warning.

6.1.2 Teaching first-year MAE students

6.1.2.1 My role

6.1.2.2 Training

6.1.2.3 Lessons learnt

6.2 Other field activities

References

- [1] World Health Organization. *Syphilis*. 2024. URL: <https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/syphilis> [Accessed 14 April 2025].